Ottoman Empire, the NILI underground and the activities of Sarah Aaronsohn. That does not mean, of course, that there are several entirely separate realities, or that there are no historical facts. There is just one reality, but it is complex.

Reality includes an objective level with objective facts that don't depend on people's beliefs; for example, it is an objective fact that Sarah Aaronsohn died on 9 October 1917, from self-inflicted gunshot wounds. Saying that 'Sarah Aaronsohn died in an airplane crash on 15 May 1919' is an error.

Reality also includes a subjective level with subjective facts like the beliefs and feelings of various people, but in this case, too, facts can be separated from errors. For example, it is a fact that Israelis tend to regard Aaronsohn as a patriotic hero. Three weeks after her suicide, the information NILI supplied helped the British finally break the Ottoman line at the Battle of Beersheba (31 October 1917) and the Third Battle of Gaza (1–2 November 1917). On 2 November 1917, the British foreign secretary, Arthur Balfour, issued the Balfour Declaration, announcing that the British government 'view with favour the establishment in Palestine of a national home for the Jewish people'. Israelis credit this in part to NILI and Sarah Aaronsohn, whom they admire for her sacrifice. It is another fact that Palestinians evaluate things very differently. Rather than admiring Aaronsohn, they regard her – if they've heard about her at all – as an imperialist agent. Even though we are dealing here with subjective views and feelings, we can still distinguish truth from falsehood. For views and feelings – just like stars and pigeons – are a part of the universal reality. Saying that 'Sarah Aaronsohn is admired by everyone for her role in defeating the Ottoman Empire' is an error, not in line with reality.

Nationality is not the only thing that affects people's viewpoint. Israeli men and Israeli women may see Aaronsohn differently, and so do left-wingers and right-wingers, or Orthodox and secular Jews. Since suicide is forbidden by Jewish religious law, Orthodox Jews have difficulty seeing Aaronsohn's suicide as a heroic act (she was actually denied burial in the hallowed ground of a Jewish cemetery). Ultimately, each individual has a different perspective on the world, shaped by the intersection of different personalities and life histories. Does this imply that when we wish to describe reality, we must always list all the different viewpoints it contains and that a truthful biography of Sarah Aaronsohn, for example, must specify how every single Israeli and Palestinian has felt about her?